19 churches. Several ways to model them.

How does classification affect which Christian denominations a query can find?

19
selected church bodies

16
match the main path

3
do not match

A missed match is a finding about the data path—not a verdict on the church.

The investigation got broader—then smaller.

1,367	**Direct instances of Christian denomination** A narrow classification count.
1,670	**Instances including subclasses** More hierarchy, more records—not a world total.
388,732	**Items with a qualifying Christian affiliation** Affiliation also retrieves buildings, people, and other kinds of things.
2,330	**Distinct direct types in that affiliation result** QLever revealed how mixed the candidate pool was.

Decision: review 19 named bodies instead of claiming a complete denomination count.

One instance step. Then climb the hierarchy.

```
?church wdt:P31/wdt:P279* wd:Q879146
```

Direct match

Presbyterian Church in America — instance of → Christian denomination

Inherited match

Church of Scotland — instance of → national Church — subclass of → Christian denomination

The * means zero or more subclass steps. Start with a body, then follow its type.

The same question produces uneven coverage.

15 direct matches + Church of Scotland through the hierarchy = 16 matches

The three missed records

Free Methodist Church	religious denomination + organization
Lutheran Church of Australia	religious denomination + religious organization
Evangelical Free Church of America	religious organization (preferred rank)

A broader religious type does not establish membership in the Christian subclass.

Some differences matter. Some are harmless.

Rank changes visibility

EFCA has a normal Protestant church type hidden by a preferred organization type. Neither type reaches the target.

Specificity changes retrieval

Religious denomination is broader than Christian denomination. The hierarchy cannot infer the narrower membership.

Names and scale raise questions

Church of South India has Anglican wording; Catholic Church is typed as church congregation. Both deserve closer review.

Multiple types can be compatible

Organization and Christian denomination can coexist. An extra broad type is not automatically a contradiction.

Would a subclass-only query find more?

```
?candidate wdt:P279+ wd:Q879146
```

0 **of our 19 match this route**

It recovers none of the three misses.

58 **extra candidates beyond the sample**

Excluded by the original instance route.

But the extras mix categories and named bodies:

national Church • state church • World Mission Society Church of God

More results are not automatically more distinct denominations.

How well are denominations represented?

What this small study establishes

Classification choices and statement ranks affect discoverability. A successful match does not certify good modeling.

What it does not establish

A complete denomination count—or that every modeling difference is an error.

Next: review the 58 candidates, inspect alternative classifications and names, and distinguish justified variation from repairable gaps.

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